Wonjin Seo

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Education

Yonsei University — Seoul, Korea
M.A. in Economics (in progress) — September 2025 - Present

- GPA: 4.30 / 4.30

Yonsei University — Seoul, Korea
B.A. in Economics and Applied Statistics (Double Major) — March 2019 - August 2025

- GPA: 4.20 / 4.30 (Rank: 8 / 236), GPA (Econ): 4.22 / 4.30, GPA (Stat & Math): 4.25 / 4.30
- Selected Coursework:
  Graduate (taken as an undergraduate): Microeconomics (A+), Econometrics (A+)
  Mathematics (proof-based): Analysis I (A+), Probability and Random Processes (A+; measure-theoretic)

University of Birmingham — Birmingham, United Kingdom
Exchange Student — September 2023 - December 2023

Leave of Absence: Military Service — Osan Air Base (U.S.–ROK)
Republic of Korea Air Force — July 2021 - April 2023

Fields of Interest

Industrial Organization, Digital Economics, International Trade

Working Papers

[1] **How Does Trade Competition with a Technological Leader Reshape Domestic Innovation?**
Sole author

Firms facing import competition may change not only how much they innovate but also *where*. Korea's abolition of Japan-specific import restrictions increased imports of treated products from Japan by 66% and reduced patenting in exposed technologies by 19%, especially where Japan's initial lead was larger. Firms with more prior experience outside affected fields reallocated more strongly and sustained total patenting; those concentrated in exposed fields reallocated less and gradually reduced patenting. Reallocation favored technologies gaining momentum abroad before liberalization.

Presented at: NEUDC 2026 (Cornell University); Midwest International Trade & Theory Conference 2026 (Toronto Metropolitan University); APTS 2026 (HKUST)

[2] **Premium or Penalty? Consumer Inference from the Sponsored Label**
Sole author **Under review at *Marketing Science***

The "Sponsored" label makes a listing less attractive in some markets and more attractive in others. I develop a model in which sponsored placement serves both to signal quality and to provide visibility to sellers passed over by the organic algorithm. Consumers favor organic listings under a precise algorithm but sponsored listings under a noisy one. Greater algorithm noise improves the sponsored pool yet lowers overall displayed quality. Mandatory sponsorship disclosure strengthens the platform's incentive to monetize the label's informational value and can therefore backfire by inducing greater noise.

Presented at: Korean Econometric Society Summer Conference 2026 (KAIST)

Work in Progress

[1] Generative AI and the Restructuring of Digital Competition

with Paul S. Koh

Studies the dynamics of consumer demand for generative AI apps, including adoption and subscription decisions, and how AI use reshapes demand for other digital services through changes in time allocation and spending. The project will link daily smartphone app usage with card-payment records for nearly 50,000 Korean consumers from 2022 onward, distinguishing initial adoption from paid subscription.

Funding secured: Approximately US$21,000 from the Yonsei Institute for AI and Social Innovation.

[2] Identification and Estimation of Discrete Choice Models with a Fixed Latent Information Structure

with Paul S. Koh

Studies discrete choice when agents' information is unobserved but assumed fixed across markets. Characterizes the additional identifying restrictions from common information and derives exact continuous-prior formulations, including a finite linear program for scalar binary choice. Develops scalable computation and confidence regions for structural parameters and counterfactual outcomes.

[3] The Production of Artificial Intelligence: Evidence from Korean AI Firms

with Paul S. Koh and Devesh Raval

Uses linked firm-level microdata from the Korean Artificial Intelligence Industry Survey to study how specialized labor, R&D, accumulated knowledge, computing resources, and cloud use shape AI production and productivity. Examines cross-firm productivity dispersion and the roles of talent, intangible assets, and computing infrastructure.

Presentations and Discussions

Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC) — Cornell University, USA
Presenter and Discussant — November 2026

Midwest International Trade & Theory Conference — TMU, Canada
Presenter — October 2026

The 21st Meeting of the Asia Pacific Trade Seminars (APTS) — HKUST, Hong Kong
Presenter — July 2026

Other

Junior Scholar Club (JSC) Student Workshop, Yonsei University — October 2026
Korean Econometric Society Summer Conference, KAIST — August 2026
Korea International Economic Association Summer Conference — August 2026
Korea's Allied Economic Associations Annual Meeting, Chung-Ang University (Discussant) — February 2026
Yonsei–Keio Economics Graduate Workshop, Yonsei University — August 2025

Awards and Honors

2025 DB Insurance and Finance Contest — DB Insurance
Honorable Mention, Economics Division

Highest Honors — Yonsei University
Top 1% within college — Spring 2021

High Honors — Yonsei University
Top 3% within college — Fall 2020

Honors — Yonsei University
Top 10% within college — Spring 2019; Spring 2024

Fellowships and Scholarships

Brain Korea 21 FOUR Program — National Research Foundation of Korea
Graduate Research Fellowship — September 2025 - Present

Merit-Based Scholarship — Yonsei University
Spring 2021; Fall 2023

Research Grants

Institute for AI and Social Innovation — Yonsei University
Generative AI and the Restructuring of Digital Competition — September 2026
- Participating Researcher; funding **KRW 30,000,000 (approx. US$21,000)**

Research Assistant and Teaching Experience

Research Assistant for Prof. Jong-Hee Hahn — Yonsei University
AI-Generated Synthetic Data: Economic and Social Impacts and Applications — September 2025 - Present

Research Assistant for Prof. Younghoon Kim — National University of Singapore
Historical event research and data collection — August 2026

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Paul S. Koh — Yonsei University
- Econometrics I (Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026) — September 2025 - Present
- Applied Microeconometric Analysis (Spring 2026)

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Jong-Hee Hahn — Yonsei University
- Industrial Organization (Fall 2025, Spring 2026) — September 2025 - Present
- Economics of Industrial Strategy (Fall 2025)
- Economics of Platforms and Networks (Fall 2026)

Econometrics Tutor — Yonsei University
Merit-Based Peer Tutoring Program — Fall 2024
⇒ Selected based on academic performance to tutor undergraduate students in Econometrics.

Research Activities and Service

Yonsei Structural Economics Reading Group (YSERG) — Yonsei University
Organizer and Participant — January 2026 - Present

Yonsei Microeconomics Reading Group — Yonsei University
Participant — Summer 2024 - Present

Yonsei Applied Microeconomics Reading Group — Yonsei University
Participant — 2025

Junior Scholar Club (JSC), Economics Chapter — Yonsei University
Academic Affairs Director (2025); Participant — Spring 2024 - Spring 2026

Standardized Tests

GRE General Test
Verbal 160 (82nd percentile); Quantitative 170 (89th percentile); Analytical Writing 4.0 (63rd percentile)

TOEFL iBT (1–6 scale)
Overall 5.5 (equivalent to 110/120); Reading 6; Listening 6; Writing 5; Speaking 5

Japanese-Language Proficiency Test (JLPT)
N1 (highest level), 178/180

Skills and Languages

- **Computer Skills:** R, Python, Julia, Stata, LaTeX
- **Languages:** Korean (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Fluent)